

## Reading Event Logs (Brute Force)

### Overview

A brute force attack came originating from IP 10.10.53.248 successfully compromised the Administrator account on THM-PC via RDP at 10:53:41 PM. Detected using Windows Event Viewer. MITRE ATT&CK: T1110.001 – Brute Force: Password Guessing

As a SOC analyst I wouldn't know in advance what kind of attack I would be dealing with, but this shows what a brute force attack will look like if I see failed logon (4625) clustered together. This lab uses a misconfigured/older system with NLA disabled; this will result in logon type 10 for RDP. I know in Modern environments logon types 3 is more common for RDP authentication.

Tool used: Windows Event Viewer

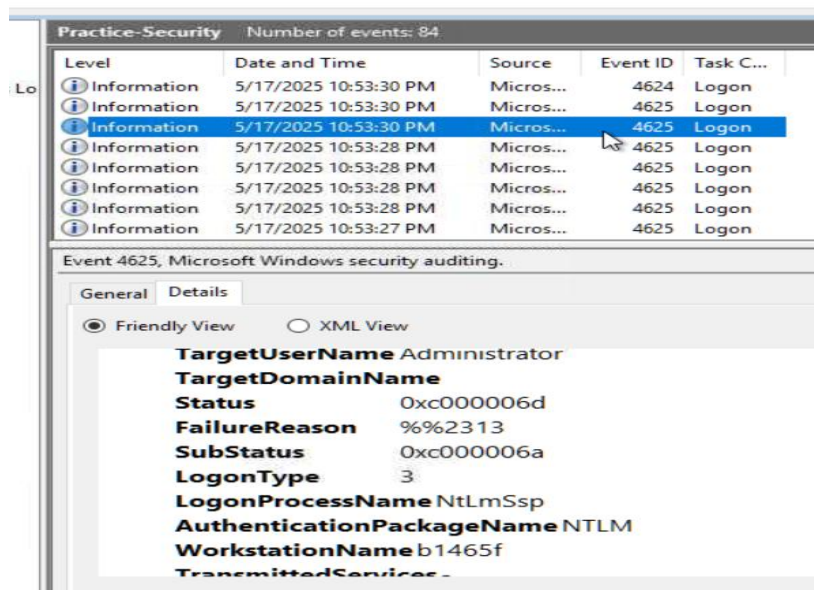
Log Source: Windows Logs > Security

I used Event Viewer in this room on TryHackMe, I searched Event viewer then clicked the Windows log drop down and clicked the security button bringing me to the security events. I am looking through the Events for ID 4625 (failed logon) and 4624 (successful login), and the log source is security. 4625 events are failed attempts, so I am looking in the logs to find any 4625. I noticed several 4625s which could possibly mean brute force or password spraying, I then clicked on the first 4625 event to view the details.

From the first 4625 event I was able to find the Source IP attempting the attack and the account being target. I then scrolled forward through the logs looking for 4624 events from the same Source IP, that would confirm the brute force was successful. I found a 4624 event with logon type 10 which confirmed the attacker gained access through RDP.

Brute Force Started:

- Timestamp of first failed attempt: 5/17/2025 10:53:28 PM
- Event ID 4625 (Failed Logon)
- Source IP 10.10.53.248
- Logon Type 3 (Network – attacker connecting over network)
- Target username: Administrator
- Attacking machine name: b1465f



## Breach Confirmation

- Event ID: 4624 (Successful Logon)
- Timestamp: 5/17/2025 10:53:41 PM
- Source IP: 10.10.53.248
- Logon type: 10 (RDP - NLA disabled)
- Target username: Administrator
- Target Workstation: THM-PC
- Logon ID: 0x183c36d

Practice-Security Number of events: 84

| Level       | Date and Time         | Source    | Event ID | Task C... |
|-------------|-----------------------|-----------|----------|-----------|
| Information | 5/17/2025 10:53:41 PM | Micros... | 4624     | Logon     |
| Information | 5/17/2025 10:53:41 PM | Micros... | 4648     | Logon     |
| Information | 5/17/2025 10:53:41 PM | Micros... | 4798     | User A... |
| Information | 5/17/2025 10:53:41 PM | Micros... | 4624     | Logon     |
| Information | 5/17/2025 10:53:41 PM | Micros... | 4624     | Logon     |

Event 4624, Microsoft Windows security auditing.

General Details

☐ Friendly View ☒ XML View

```

<Data Name="TargetUserName">Administrator</Data>
<Data Name="TargetDomainName">THM-PC</Data>
<Data Name="TargetLogonId">0x183c36d</Data>
<Data Name="LogonType">10</Data>
<Data Name="LogonProcessName">User32</Data>
<Data Name="AuthenticationPackageName">Negotiate</Data>
<Data Name="WorkstationName">THM-PC</Data>
<Data Name="LogonGuid">{00000000-0000-0000-0000-000000000000}</Data>
<Data Name="TransmittedServices">-</Data>
<Data Name="LmPackageName">-</Data>
<Data Name="KeyLength">0</Data>
<Data Name="ProcessId">0x8d8</Data>
<Data Name="ProcessName">C:\Windows\System32\svchost.exe</Data>
<Data Name="IpAddress">10.10.53.248</Data>
<Data Name="IpPort">0</Data>
<Data Name="ImpersonationLevel">0%1833</Data>

```

## End and Escalation

A brute force attack came from IP 10.10.53.248 (b1465f) targeting the administrator account on THM-PC. The attacker made multiple attempts that failed beginning at 10:53:28 PM and gained RDP access at 10:53:41 PM. This incident has been escalated to L2/L3 for investigation using logon ID 0x183c36d to track the attacker's activity.